ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Sleep, Fitness and Posture: The Physical Habits Behind Good Grades

Small daily routines that protect memory, mood and your back

HEALTH & WELLBEING

Health & Wellbeing

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Sleep and movement are not luxuries to be traded for study hours - they are part of how learning is consolidated. This pack covers sleep hygiene, a no-equipment exercise routine, posture for long study sessions and recovering after late nights.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Explain the role of sleep in memory and mood.
- Apply sleep-hygiene practices in a hostel environment.
- Follow a simple weekly exercise routine without equipment.
- Correct posture during long study sessions and screen use.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Sleep is study time

Memory consolidation happens during sleep, so cutting sleep reduces what you keep.

- Adults need roughly seven to nine hours, with consistent timing.
- Sleep supports memory consolidation, emotional regulation and immune function.
- Caffeine after mid-afternoon and late-night screens delay sleep onset.
- All-nighters produce short-term recall but impair understanding and accuracy.
- A consistent wind-down routine signals the body to sleep.
- If you must sleep late, keep the wake time stable rather than shifting both.

> **After a late night**
> Prioritise a short recovery nap, daylight, water and a normal bedtime the next day. Sleeping all day resets your rhythm in the wrong direction.

Movement without a gym

Consistency matters more than intensity.

- Aim for 150 minutes of moderate activity per week, spread across days.
- Bodyweight basics: squats, push-ups (wall or floor), lunges, planks, glute bridges.
- Walking briskly to lectures counts as activity.
- Stretch hip flexors, hamstrings and chest after long sitting.
- Warm up for five minutes and progress gradually.
- Stop and seek advice if you feel chest pain, dizziness or joint injury.

Posture and screen habits

Long hours hunched over a phone affect neck, shoulders and concentration.

- Raise your screen to eye level and keep feet flat on the floor.
- Keep the lower back supported and elbows near 90 degrees.
- Follow the 20-20-20 rule: every 20 minutes, look 20 feet away for 20 seconds.
- Stand and move for two minutes every 45 to 60 minutes.
- Carry bags evenly or use a backpack with two straps.
- Do not study lying flat with a laptop on your chest.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Why does sleep matter for academic performance?

Answer: Sleep consolidates memory, restores attention and regulates mood, all of which directly affect learning and exam performance.

2. What is the 20-20-20 rule?

Answer: Every 20 minutes, look at something about 20 feet away for 20 seconds to reduce eye strain.

3. List four bodyweight exercises that need no equipment.

Answer: Squats, push-ups, lunges and planks. Glute bridges and step-ups also qualify.

4. Why is a consistent wake time important?

Answer: It anchors the body clock, making sleep onset and waking more predictable.

5. Give two posture corrections for laptop study.

Answer: Raise the screen to eye level and keep feet flat with the lower back supported.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Set a consistent sleep and wake time for two weeks.
- [ ] Create a 20-minute wind-down routine without screens.
- [ ] Plan three 30-minute activity sessions for the week.
- [ ] Learn a five-minute stretching routine.
- [ ] Adjust your study desk to eye-level screen height.
- [ ] Apply the 20-20-20 rule during one study session.
- [ ] Track sleep and energy for a week and compare.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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